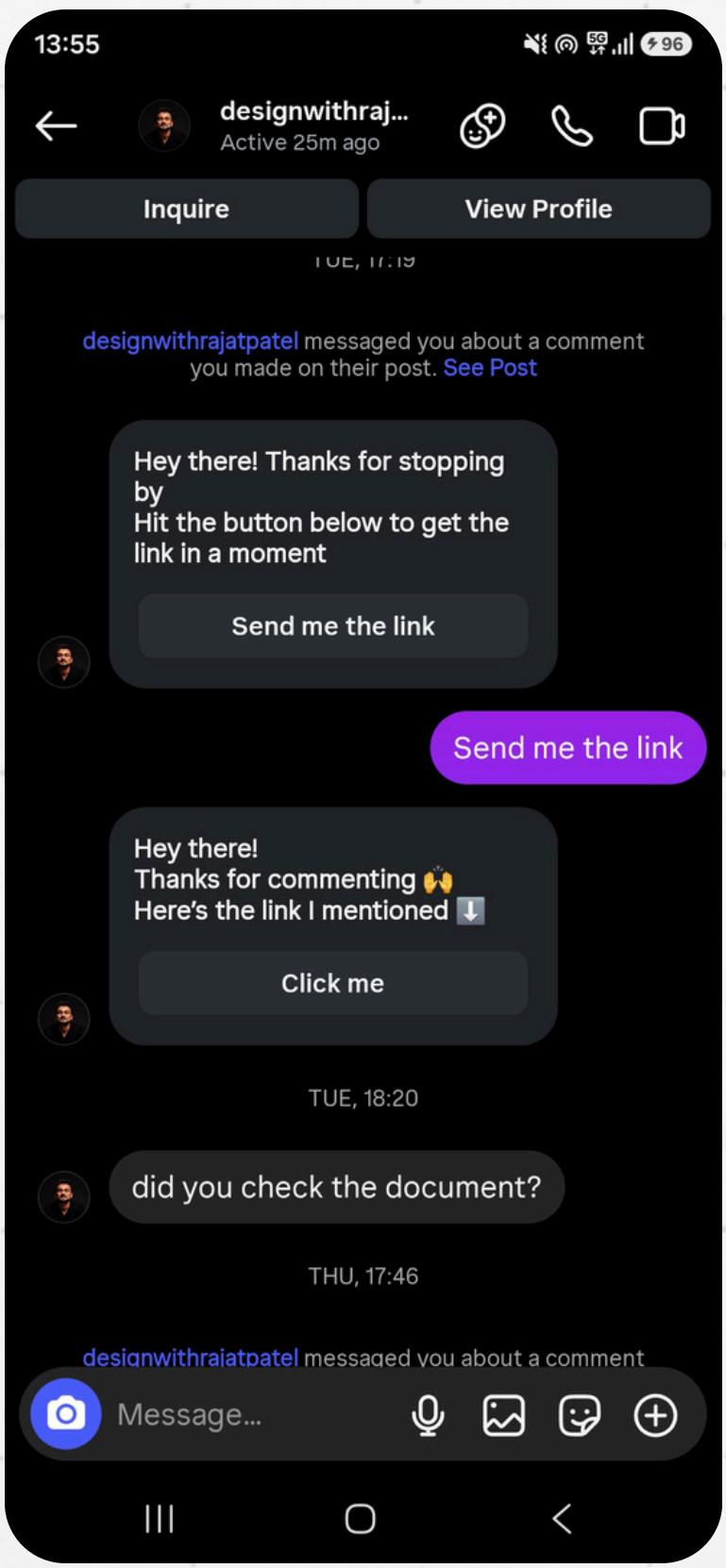
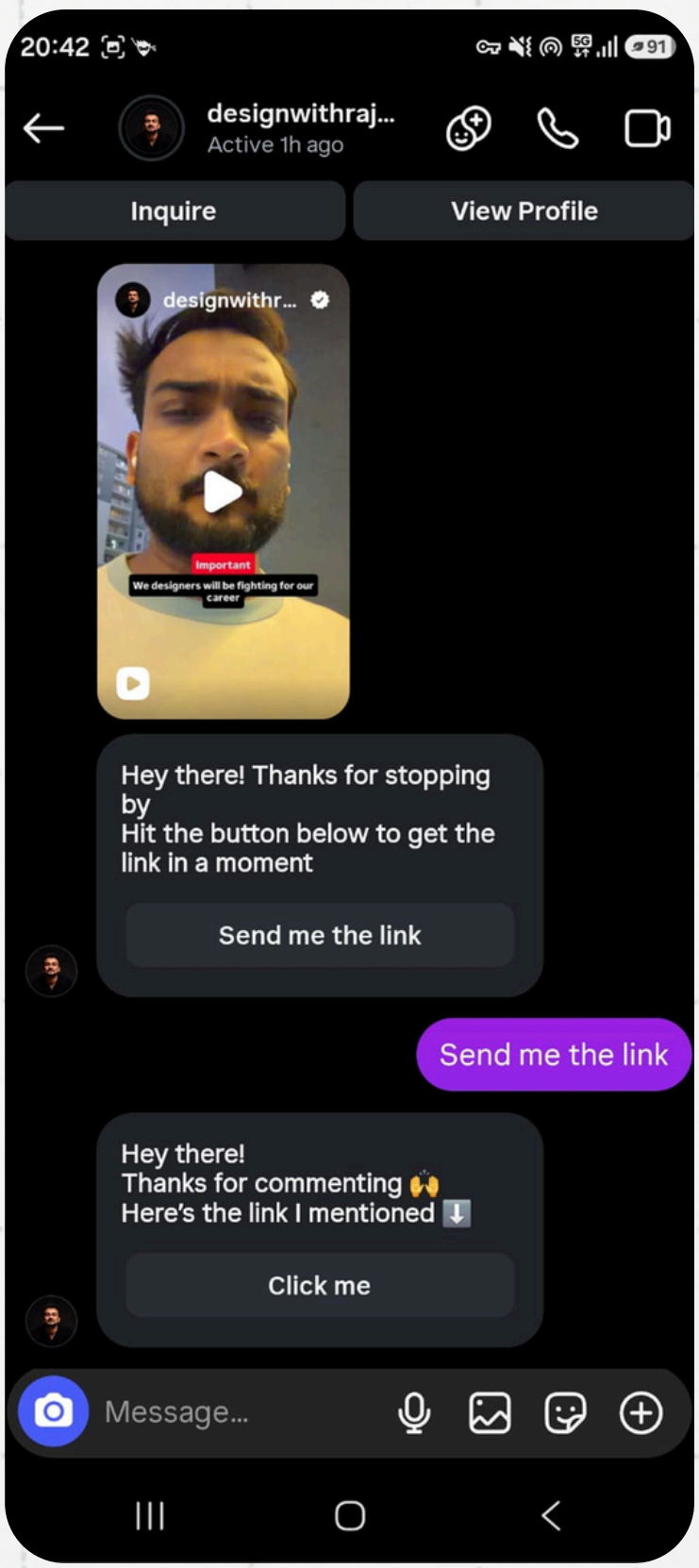
How I helped Instagram users get more context on the resources creators send them in DMs ?

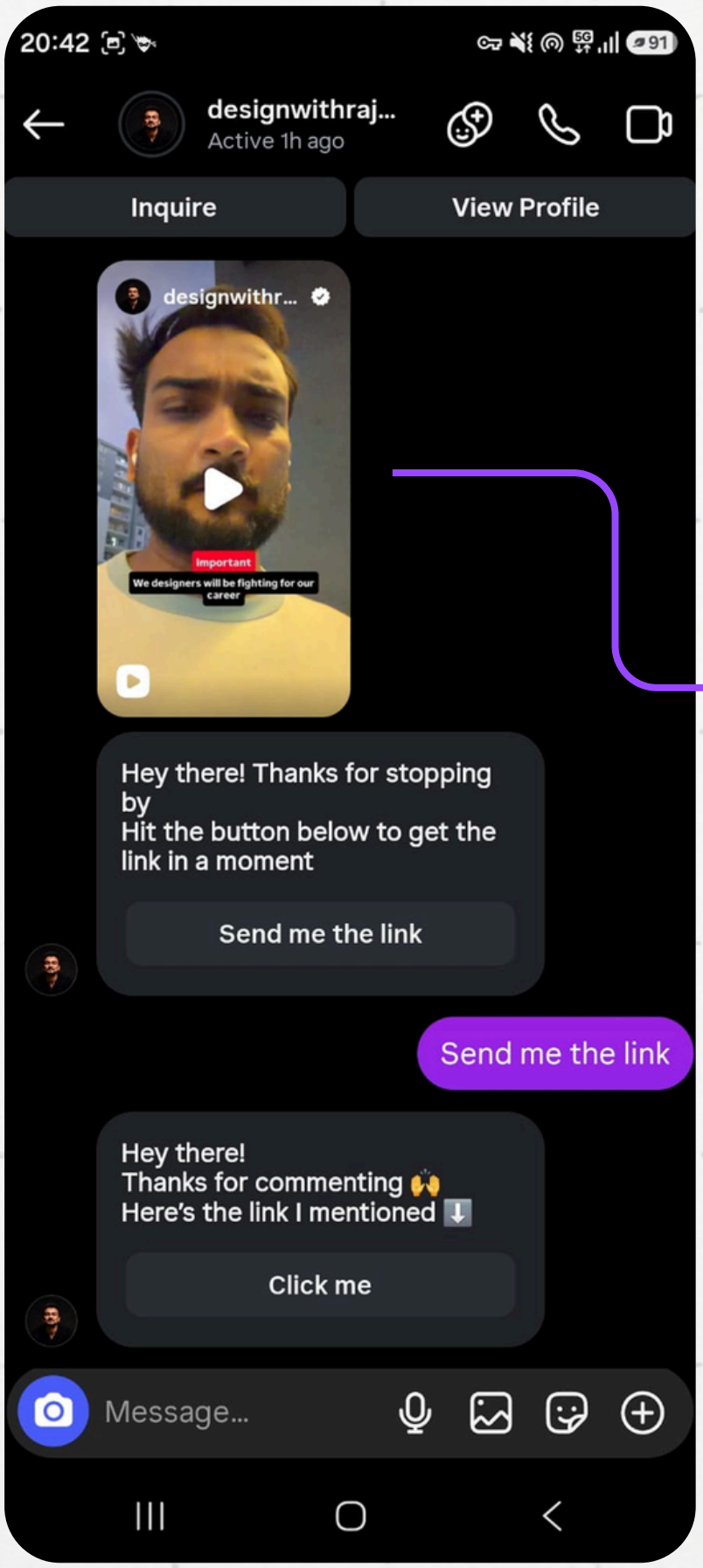




We comment on creators' posts to get resources but rarely open them actively, so our DMs fill up with links, and later it's hard to tell which is which or what context each came from

Let's see how I improved the current experience.

I added a visual cue of a quoted post to each resource that the user taps on to instantly see the post it came from



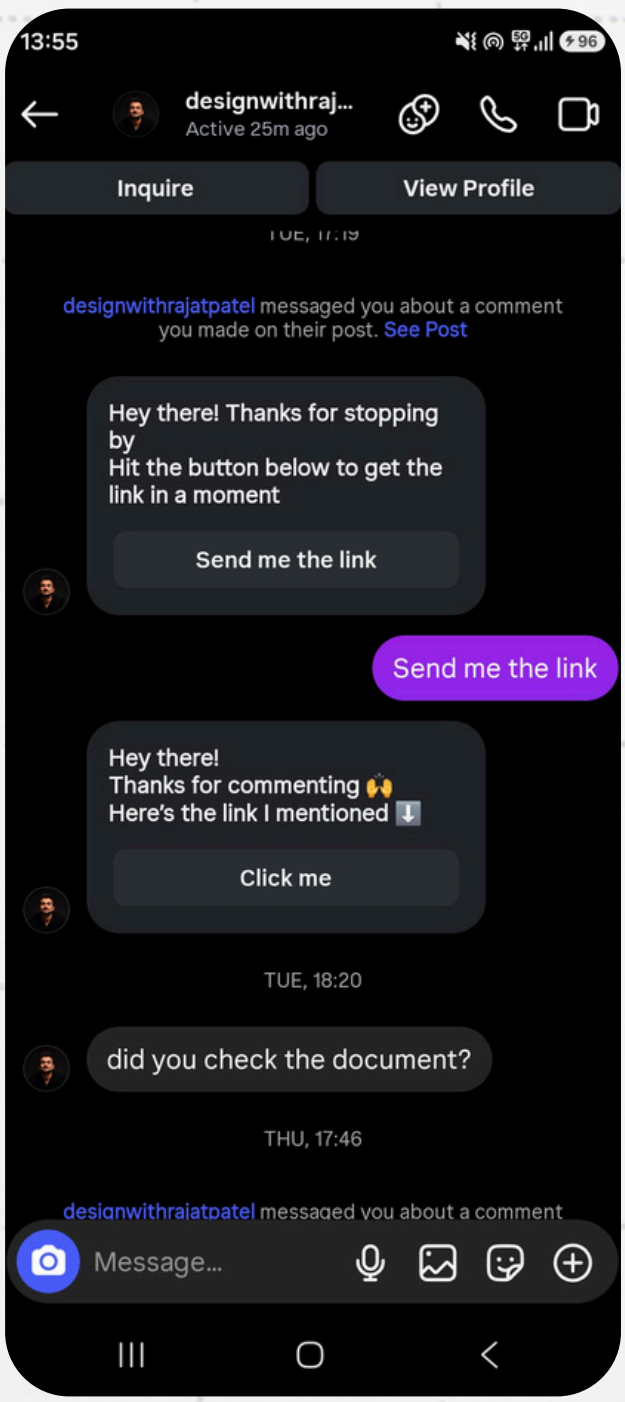


Design decision I took

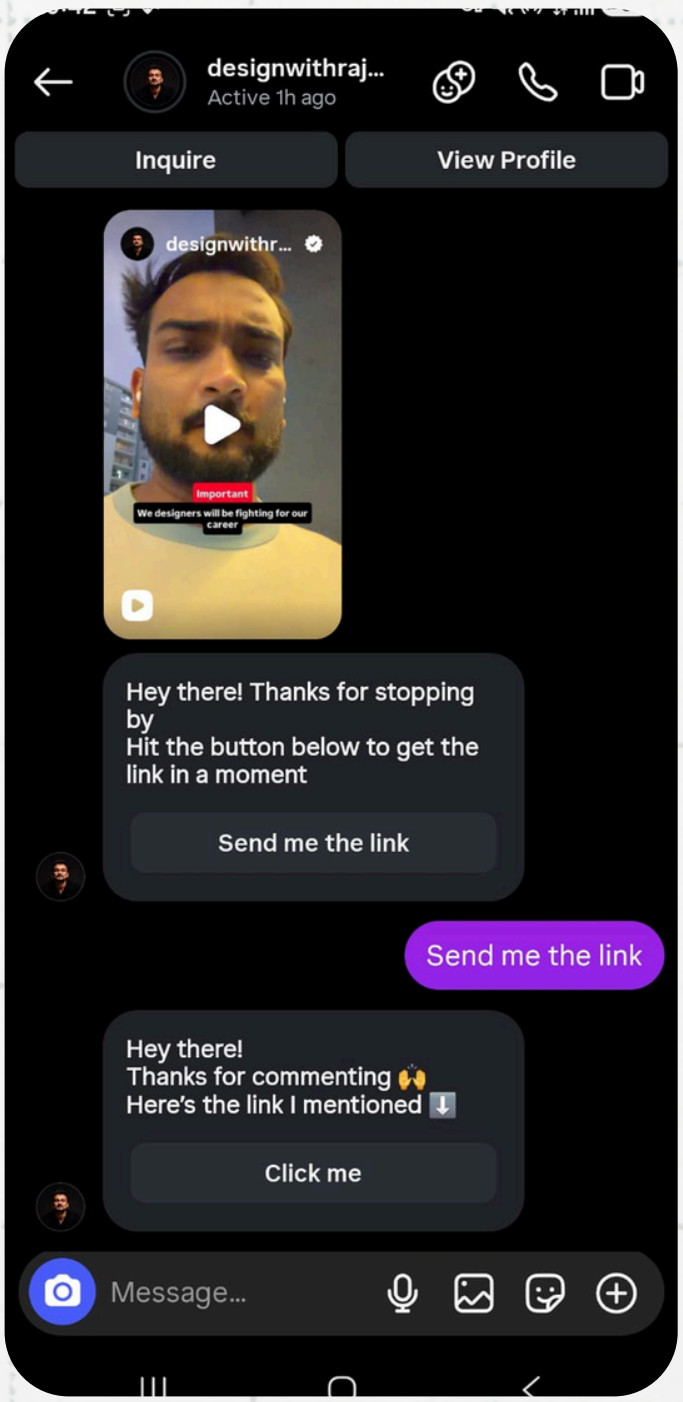
I decided to show the post itself as a quoted preview above the resource, instead of relying on the "See Post" text link.

By providing more clue of context for every resource by quoting the post, users get a better chance of **recognition over recall**. Reduces **cognitive load** on the user as well.

Also **Fitts' law** of interaction design is observed



Before



After

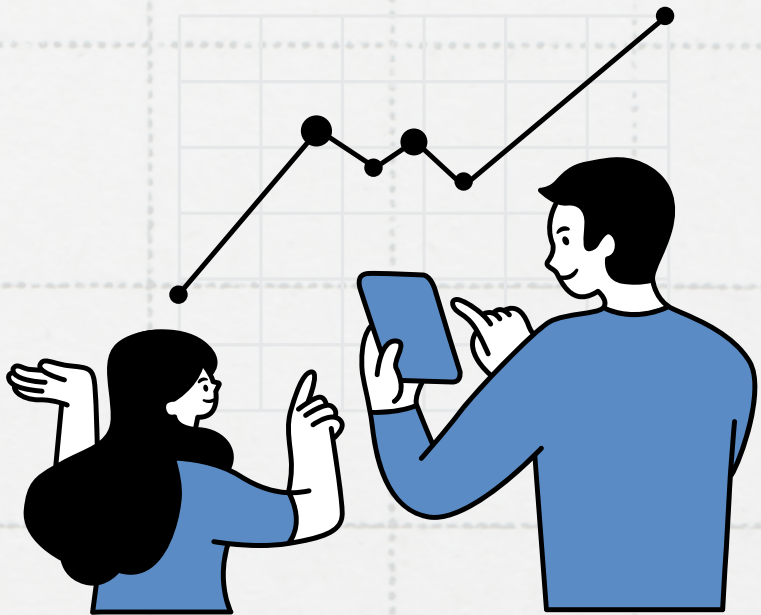
Metrics it improves

Task Success rate measures how many people complete the task.

When the user feels it is easier to check out the post from the quoted post, they will have a smoother experience of revisiting the resources, improving the success rate of lookoing into the resources

CES (Customer Effort Score) measures how easy a task was

Reducing cognitive load by adding the quoted post and larger tappable area for seeing the post from where the resource came from improves the perceived efficiency of the task



But this is not the only idea I had..

I explored multiple ideas before coming to the final idea.

Let us see some of them and the constraints they were subjected to, which made me deprioritize them •••

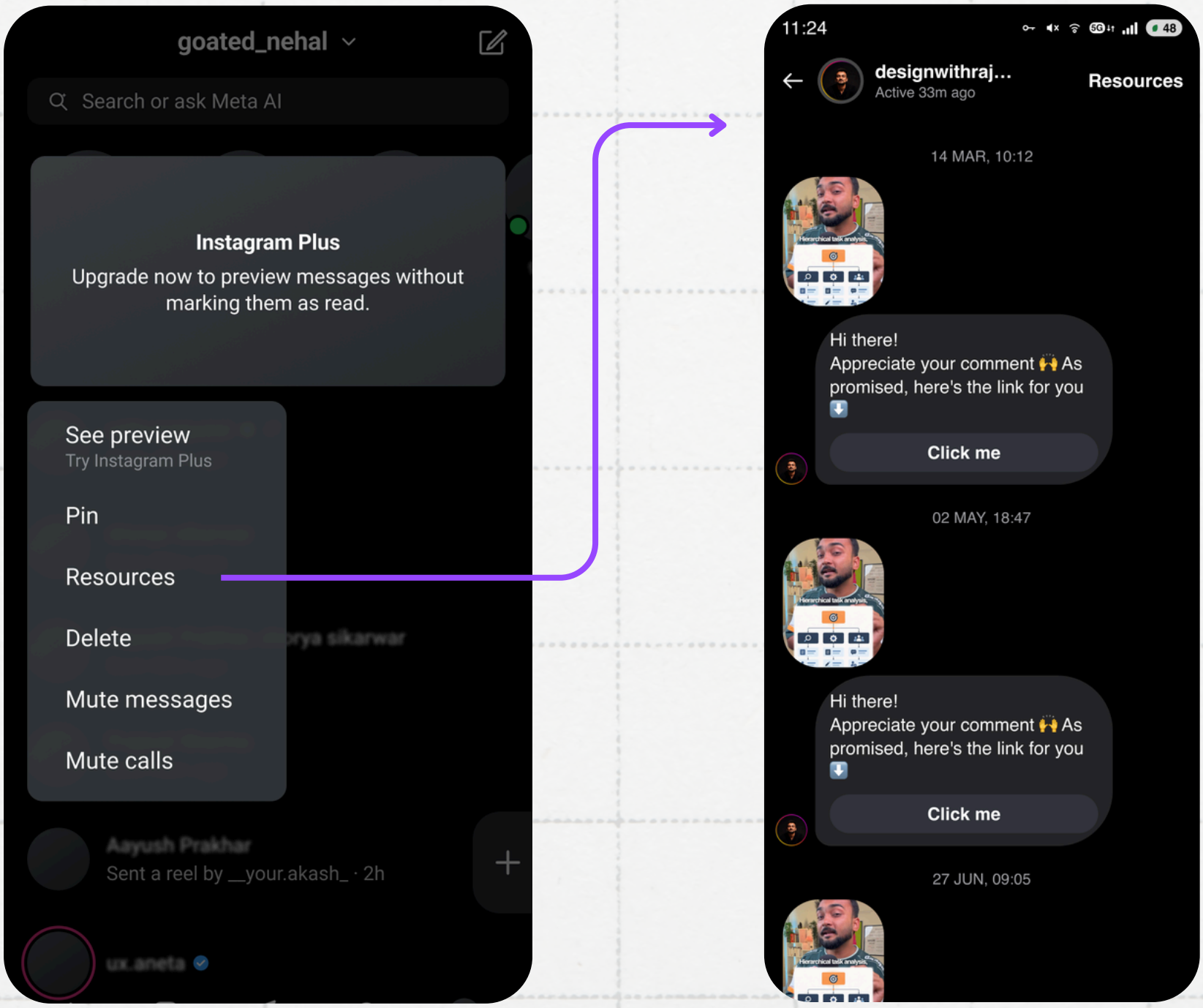


Explored Idea #1

Long pressing on account shows resources gained from them in a new page

Constraint

No data found that Insta has the algorithm to map the resource and the post from which it came. It only knows the first auto text that is sent after user comments but often it doesn't contain the resource link. Any text after the first auto text is read as normal chat

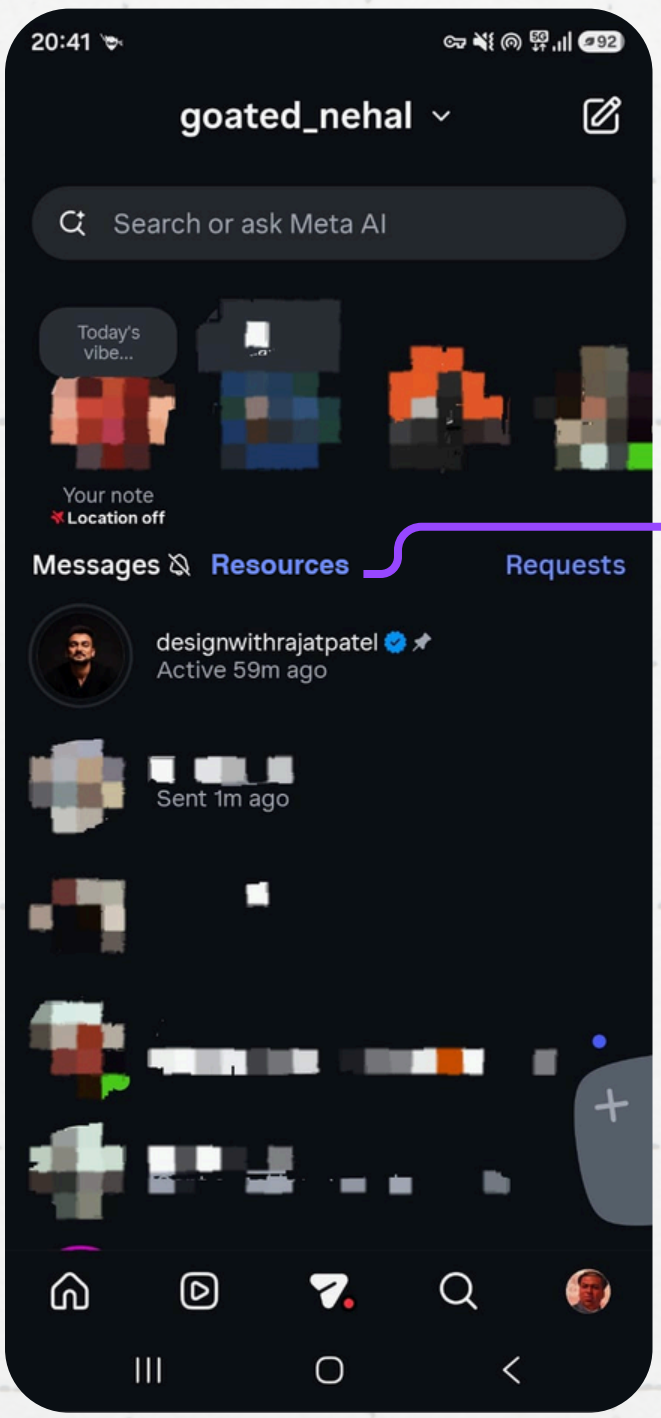


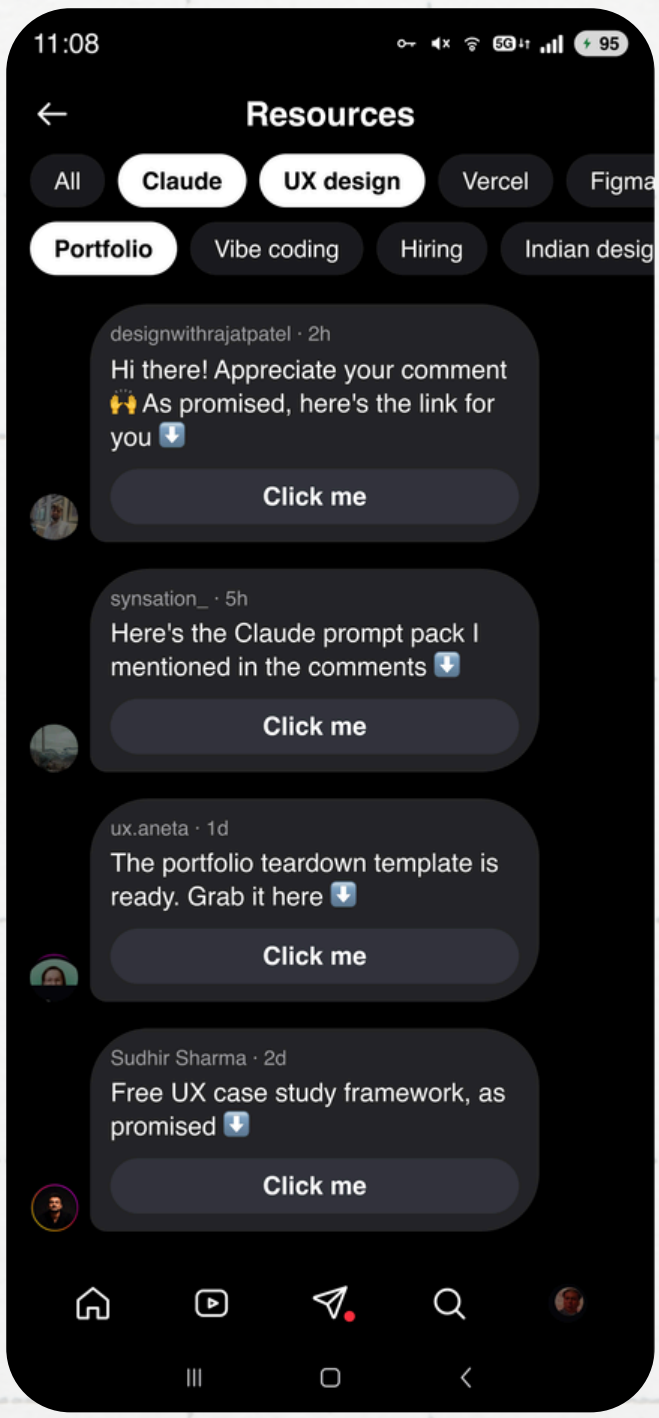
Explored Idea #2

Resource option to access the entire repository of resources, with quick filters of the category it sits in

Constraint

Meta AI has conferred that their reading of the post or transcribing isnt accurate, and no evidence were found which suggests that the algorithm can map a hyperlink to the post it came from. The first auto text from the creator can be mapped to the post.



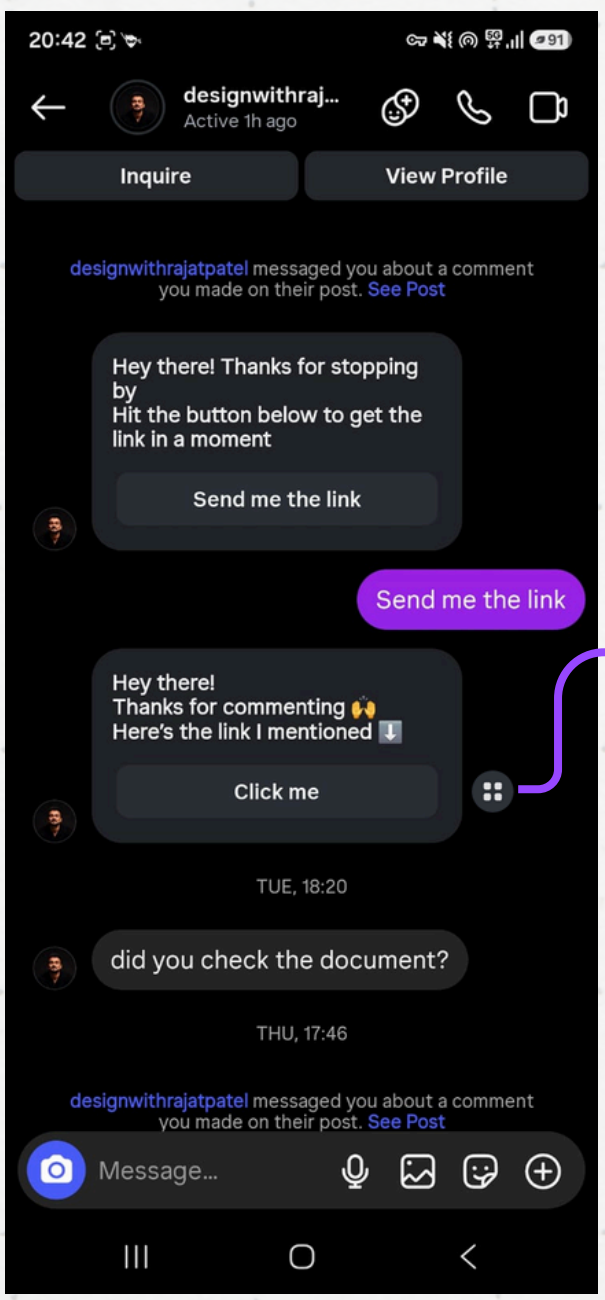


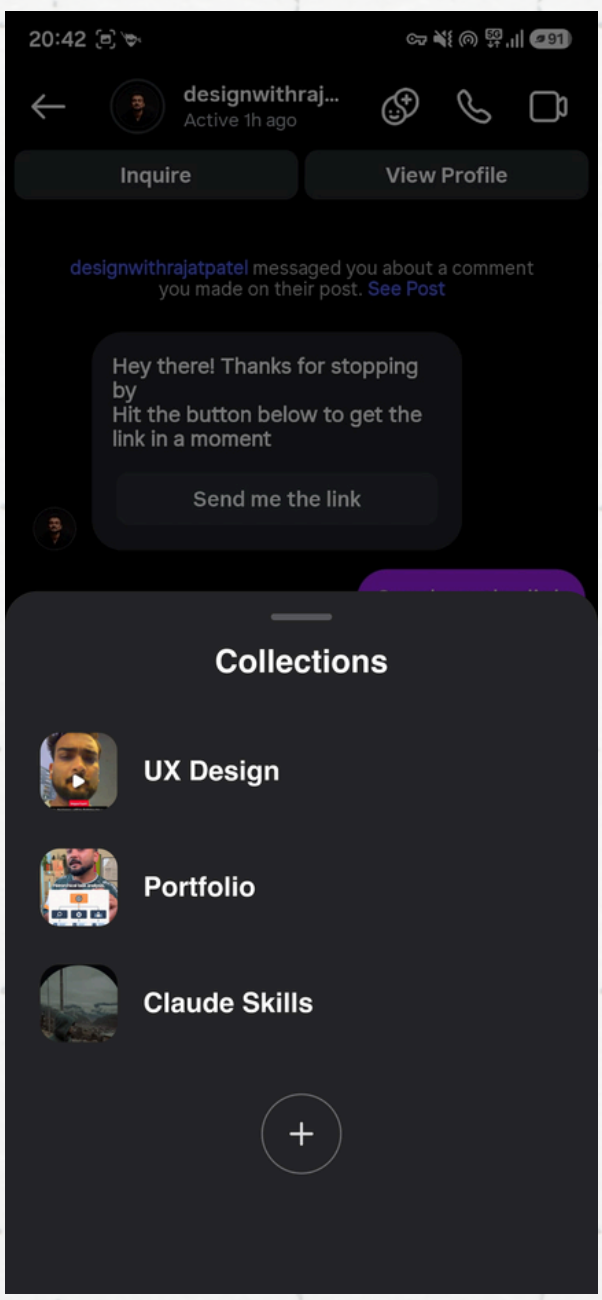
Explored Idea #3

Curating user controlled collection(s) of resources named under their categories. Collections accessible from the message page itself

Constraint

Completely new feature. Development





Easy access to collections

